

D763

Assessment for Special Education

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A third grader earns a standard score of 85 on a reading achievement test (mean 100, SD 15). The test took 90 minutes and was given in the library. How should the teacher describe this score?

- A. One standard deviation below the mean, at about the 16th percentile.
- B. Invalid because 90 minutes is too long.
- C. 85% of items correct.
- D. Two standard deviations below the mean.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A student's z-score on a math test is -1.4 . On a scale with mean 100 and SD 15, what is the standard score?

- A. 98.6
- B. 79
- C. 86
- D. 121

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A student scores 90 on a test with an SEM of 3. The student was tested by a new school psychologist, and the test was published in 2019. What is the approximate 95% confidence band?

- A. 84 to 96
- B. 87 to 93
- C. 90 exactly
- D. 81 to 99

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A report says a student's 68% confidence band is 82 to 88. What is the SEM?

- A.** 1.5
- B.** 3
- C.** 85
- D.** 6

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A district uses a new reading test that gives nearly the same scores when students retake it a week later. Teachers find it only asks students to name letters, yet it is used to judge reading comprehension. The test is popular in neighboring districts. What is the problem?

- A.** It is neither reliable nor valid.
- B.** It is valid because other districts use it.
- C.** It is reliable but not valid for judging comprehension.
- D.** It is valid but not reliable.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which statement about reliability and validity is correct?

- A.** A reliable test is always valid.
- B.** Reliability and validity are the same.
- C.** A valid test can have very low reliability.
- D.** A test cannot be valid if it is not reliable.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

At an IEP meeting, a parent sees her son scored at the 40th percentile in math and says, "So he only got 40% right?" The meeting is at 3:30 and the school counselor attends. What is the accurate explanation?

- A.** He is below 60% of students, so he failed.
- B.** He scored as well as or better than about 40% of same-age students in the norm group.
- C.** The counselor must explain it later.
- D.** Yes, he answered 40% of items correctly.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A student answered 92% of items correctly on an easy grade-level test that most students ace. What can be said about her percentile rank?

- A.** It is the 92nd percentile.
- B.** It must be above the 90th percentile.
- C.** It is the 8th percentile.
- D.** It could be low, because many peers may have scored higher.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A team evaluating a fourth grader who speaks mostly Spanish at home plans to use one English IQ test to decide eligibility. The student arrived two years ago and loves soccer. What does IDEA require?

- A.** Wait until he has been in the country five years.
- B.** Use only a soccer skills observation.
- C.** The English IQ test is enough because it is standardized.
- D.** Use a variety of tools, assess in the language most likely to yield accurate information, and do not use one measure as the sole basis.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

A team considers a third grader for a specific learning disability in reading. The state allows RTI data. She received 12 weeks of Tier 2 and Tier 3 reading intervention with weekly progress monitoring and made little growth. Her older sister had an IEP. What data best support SLD eligibility in this state?

- A.** Her progress-monitoring data showing poor response to evidence-based intervention, plus evidence she had appropriate reading instruction.
- B.** An IQ-achievement discrepancy of at least 22 points, required in every state.
- C.** One low reading grade on her report card.
- D.** Her sister's IEP history.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A fifth grader with a reading disability has read-aloud as an accommodation in science. The school is giving a test of decoding skills in a new computer lab with 30 stations. Should the test be read aloud?

- A.** Yes, because accommodations apply to all tests.
- B.** Yes, but only on the computer version.
- C.** No, because reading the items aloud would change what the decoding test measures.
- D.** No, and remove read-aloud in science too.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

A fall universal screener flags a first grader as at risk in reading. The screener takes five minutes, and his teacher is in her first year. What should happen next?

- A.** Tell the family he has a reading disability.
- B.** Ignore it because the screener is only five minutes.
- C.** Confirm the risk with further assessment or data and provide targeted support with progress monitoring.
- D.** Immediately write an IEP.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer A Concept 1

A third grader earns a standard score of 85 on a reading achievement test (mean 100, SD 15). ~~The test took 90 minutes and was given in the library.~~ How should the teacher describe this score?

Target word: interpret the standard score **Decides:** 85 is one SD below the mean, about the 16th percentile.

A	Correct	$85 = 100 - 15$; about 16% of the norm group score at or below that point.
B	Camouflage	Test length does not change what the score means.
C	Confusion set	Standard scores are not percent correct.
D	Wrong stem number	Two SD below would be 70.

2. Answer B Concept 1 • transfer

A student's z-score on a math test is -1.4 . On a scale with mean 100 and SD 15, what is the standard score?

Target word: solve for standard score **Decides:** $100 + (-1.4 \times 15) = 79$.

A	Wrong stem number	Subtracts 1.4 directly from 100.
B	Correct	$-1.4 \times 15 = -21$; $100 - 21 = 79$.
C	Dropped element	Subtracts 14, dropping the SD multiplication.
D	Inverted operation	Adds instead of subtracting for a negative z.

3. Answer A Concept 2

A student scores 90 on a test with an SEM of 3. ~~The student was tested by a new school psychologist, and the test was published in 2019.~~ What is the approximate 95% confidence band?

Target word: 95% band **Decides:** About ± 2 SEM = ± 6 .

A	Correct	$90 \pm (2 \times 3) = 84$ to 96.
B	Confusion set	That is the 68% band (± 1 SEM).
C	Dropped element	Ignores measurement error.
D	Wrong stem number	± 3 SEM, about 99% confidence.

4. Answer B Concept 2 • transfer

A report says a student's 68% confidence band is 82 to 88. What is the SEM?

Target word: solve for SEM **Decides:** 68% band = ± 1 SEM; half the width is 3.

A	Confusion set	Treats the band as ± 2 SEM (95%).
B	Correct	The band spans 6 points, ± 3 around 85.
C	Wrong stem number	The obtained score, not the error.
D	Dropped element	The full width, not half.

5. Answer C Concept 3

A district uses a new reading test that gives nearly the same scores when students retake it a week later. Teachers find it only asks students to name letters, yet it is used to judge reading comprehension. ~~The test is popular in neighboring districts.~~ What is the problem?

Target word: reliability without validity **Decides:** Consistent scores, but the test does not measure comprehension.

A	Dropped element	Test-retest consistency shows reliability.
B	Camouflage	Popularity is not evidence of validity.
C	Correct	Consistent scores do not mean it measures the intended skill.
D	Inverted operation	Reverses the two: scores are consistent, but the skill is wrong.

6. Answer D Concept 3 • transfer

Which statement about reliability and validity is correct?

Target word: the relationship **Decides:** Reliability is necessary but not sufficient for validity.

A	Absolute language	Consistency does not prove it measures the right thing.
B	Confusion set	Consistency and accuracy of meaning are different.
C	Inverted operation	Validity depends on reliability.
D	Correct	Inconsistent scores cannot accurately measure anything.

7. Answer B Concept 4

At an IEP meeting, a parent sees her son scored at the 40th percentile in math and says, “So he only got 40% right?” ~~The meeting is at 3:30 and the school counselor attends.~~ What is the accurate explanation?

Target word: meaning of percentile rank **Decides:** Percentile = standing compared with the norm group.

A	Absolute language	The 40th percentile is in the average range for many tests.
B	Correct	Percentile rank compares the student with peers, not items correct.
C	Camouflage	Who attends does not change the meaning.
D	Confusion set	Percentile rank is not percent correct.

8. Answer D Concept 4 • transfer

A student answered 92% of items correctly on an easy grade-level test that most students ace. What can be said about her percentile rank?

Target word: percent correct does not give percentile **Decides:** Percentile depends on how peers scored.

A	Confusion set	Treats percent correct as percentile rank.
B	Absolute language	Rank depends on the norm group’s scores.
C	Inverted operation	Subtracts percent correct from 100; still not a percentile.
D	Correct	If most students ace the test, 92% correct may rank below many peers.

9. Answer D Concept 5

A team evaluating a fourth grader who speaks mostly Spanish at home plans to use one English IQ test to decide eligibility. The student arrived two years ago ~~and loves soccer~~. What does IDEA require?

Target word: evaluation requirements **Decides:** Multiple measures, native language, no single measure.

A	Wrong stem number	No fixed waiting period; evaluate appropriately when a disability is suspected.
B	Camouflage	An unrelated observation cannot replace a full evaluation.
C	Dropped element	Drops the multi-source and language requirements.
D	Correct	These are core nondiscriminatory evaluation requirements.

10. Answer A Concept 6

A team considers a third grader for a specific learning disability in reading. The state allows RTI data. She received 12 weeks of Tier 2 and Tier 3 reading intervention with weekly progress monitoring and made little growth. ~~Her older sister had an IEP~~. What data best support SLD eligibility in this state?

Target word: SLD evidence under RTI **Decides:** Documented response to evidence-based intervention plus evidence of appropriate instruction.

A	Correct	RTI eligibility rests on response data and ruling out lack of instruction.
B	Absolute language	IDEA does not allow states to require a discrepancy.
C	Dropped element	Drops intervention data and multiple sources.
D	Camouflage	Family history does not establish her eligibility.

11. Answer C Concept 7

A fifth grader with a reading disability has read-aloud as an accommodation in science. The school is giving a test of decoding skills ~~in a new computer lab with 30 stations~~. Should the test be read aloud?

Target word: accommodation vs. construct **Decides:** Read-aloud would do the skill the test measures.

A	Absolute language	Accommodations are matched to the skill tested.
B	Camouflage	The lab detail does not change the construct.
C	Correct	An accommodation must not alter the construct being measured.
D	Inverted operation	Read-aloud is valid on the science test, where reading is not the skill.

12. Answer C Concept 8

A fall universal screener flags a first grader as at risk in reading. ~~The screener takes five minutes, and his teacher is in her first year~~. What should happen next?

Target word: meaning of a screening flag **Decides:** Screening identifies risk, not disability.

A	Adjacent category	Screening cannot diagnose a disability.
B	Camouflage	Brevity is by design; the flag still needs follow-up.
C	Correct	A screening flag leads to closer look and support, not a label.
D	Inverted operation	Skips evaluation, consent, and eligibility.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	6	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	5	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	1	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	6	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	5	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	6	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	7	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Standard scores	Most norm-referenced tests report standard scores with a mean of 100 and a standard deviation of 15, so each 15 points is one standard deviation from average.	Reading a standard score of 85 as 85% correct or as failing.	A score reported with “mean 100, SD 15.”
2	Standard error of measurement	Every score has error; a confidence band of about ± 1 SEM gives 68% confidence and about ± 2 SEM gives 95% confidence that the true score falls inside.	Treating an obtained score as exact and making cutoff decisions from a single point.	An SEM value next to an obtained score.
3	Reliability vs. validity	Reliability is consistency of scores; validity is whether the test measures what it claims for the intended use. A test can be reliable but not valid, but not valid without being reliable.	Assuming a consistent test must measure the right thing.	“Gives the same results each time” vs. “measures what it is supposed to.”
4	Percentile rank vs. percent correct	A percentile rank tells the percent of the norm group scoring at or below the student, not the percent of items answered correctly.	Telling a parent a 40th-percentile score means 40% right.	“Percentile” in a score report.
5	Nondiscriminatory, multi-source evaluation	IDEA eligibility requires a variety of tools, no single measure as the sole basis, assessment in the child’s native language or mode of communication, and tools that are not culturally biased.	Deciding eligibility from one IQ score or testing an English learner only in English.	An evaluation plan with one test or a language mismatch.
6	Identifying specific learning disabilities	States may use response to intervention data or patterns of strengths and weaknesses and may not require an IQ-achievement discrepancy; low achievement must not be due to lack of appropriate instruction.	Believing a large IQ-achievement gap is required in every state, or skipping evidence of prior instruction.	A team discusses SLD eligibility and what data to use.
7	Testing accommodations and the construct	An accommodation is valid only when it removes a barrier without changing the skill the test measures.	Reading aloud a test of decoding or allowing a calculator on a computation test.	A proposed accommodation on a specific test.
8	Screening identifies risk, not disability	Universal screening in MTSS flags students who may need support; flagged students get closer assessment or intervention, not a diagnosis.	Labeling a student as having a disability from a screening score.	A fall screening flags a student.

Course scope (public description): Assessment for Special Education prepares special education teachers to use multiple methods of assessment and data sources in making educational decisions concerning the student and their learning environment. This course is designed to help provide an understanding of how assessment data is used during screening in multitiered systems of support (MTSS), the eligibility process, the evaluation process, progress monitoring, and data-based instructional decision making.